



Creating a bootable USB with Ventoy is a two-part process: first, you install the Ventoy "framework" onto the drive, and then you simply copy your OS files over.

Phase 1: Install Ventoy to your USB Drive

Important: This step will **format your USB drive**, erasing all existing data.

For Windows Users:

1. **Download & Extract:** Get the `ventoy-x.x.xx-windows.zip` file from the [official download page](#) and extract it to a folder.
2. **Run the Installer:** Open the extracted folder and run `Ventoy2Disk.exe` as an administrator.
3. **Select Your Drive:** Choose your USB flash drive from the "Device" dropdown menu.
4. **(Optional) Configuration:** Click on **Option** and then **Partition Style**.
 - **MBR:** Best for older PCs.
 - **GPT:** Recommended for modern computers (UEFI).
5. **Install:** Click the **Install** button. You will be warned twice that the drive will be wiped—click **Yes** both times to proceed.

For Linux Users:

1. **Download & Extract:** Download the `ventoy-x.x.xx-linux.tar.gz` file and extract it.
2. **Run the GUI:** Navigate into the extracted folder. Find and double-click the `VentoyGUI` file (e.g., `VentoyGUI.x86_64`) to launch the graphical installer.
3. **Install:** Select your USB drive from the menu and click **Install**.
 - *Alternative (CLI):* Open a terminal in the folder and run `sudo sh Ventoy2Disk.sh -i /dev/sdX` (replace `sdX` with your actual drive identifier).

Phase 2: Adding Operating Systems

Once Phase 1 is complete, your USB drive will appear in your file manager as a normal storage device named "Ventoy".

1. **Download ISOs:** Obtain the `.iso` (or `.wim`, `.img`, `.vhd`) files for the operating systems you want, such as [Windows 11](#) or [Ubuntu Linux](#).
2. **Copy Files:** Simply **drag and drop** or copy/paste these files directly onto the "Ventoy" partition of your USB drive.
 - *Pro Tip:* You can organize them into folders; Ventoy will search all subdirectories automatically.
3. **Wait for Transfer:** In Linux, it is critical to run the `sync` command or safely eject the drive to ensure the cache is fully written before unplugging.



Phase 3: Booting from the USB

1. **Insert the Drive:** Plug the USB into the computer you want to boot.
2. **Access Boot Menu:** Restart the PC and repeatedly tap the **Boot Menu Key** (typically **F12**, **F11**, **F8**, or **Esc**) before the OS loads.
3. **Select USB:** Choose your USB drive from the list.
4. **Choose OS:** The Ventoy menu will appear, listing all the ISO files you copied. Select the one you want to start and press **Enter**.

